

**Important:** HTML categories overlap. A single element can be semantic + block-level + parent/container, etc. Also, "parent" and "child" describe the **DOM relationship**, not fixed categories.

## 1. Complete list of current HTML elements

### Document & metadata

| Tag     | Purpose                    |
|---------|----------------------------|
| <html>  | Root element               |
| <head>  | Metadata container         |
| <title> | Page title                 |
| <base>  | Base URL for relative URLs |
| <link>  | Links external resources   |
| <meta>  | Metadata                   |
| <style> | CSS                        |
| <body>  | Visible document content   |

### Page structure / semantic

| Tag       | Purpose      |
|-----------|--------------|
| <header>  | Header       |
| <nav>     | Navigation   |
| <main>    | Main content |
| <section> | Section      |

| Tag       | Purpose                 |
|-----------|-------------------------|
| <article> | Independent content     |
| <aside>   | Related/sidebar content |
| <footer>  | Footer                  |
| <address> | Contact information     |
| <h1>–<h6> | Headings                |
| <hgroup>  | Heading group           |
| <search>  | Search/control area     |
| <div>     | Generic block container |

## Text / paragraphs

<p>  
<br>  
<hr>  
<pre>  
<blockquote>  
<ol>  
<ul>  
<li>  
<dl>  
<dt>  
<dd>  
<figure>  
<figcaption>

## Text semantics / formatting

<a>  
<abbr>  
<b>  
<bdi>  
<bdo>  
<cite>  
<code>  
<data>  
<del>  
<dfn>  
<em>  
<i>  
<ins>  
<kbd>  
<mark>  
<q>  
<rp>  
<rt>  
<ruby>  
<s>  
<samp>  
<small>  
<span>  
<strong>  
<sub>  
<sup>  
<time>  
<u>  
<var>  
<wbr>

## Images & media

<img>  
<picture>  
<source>  
<audio>  
<video>  
<track>  
<map>  
<area>

## Embedded content

<iframe>  
<embed>  
<object>  
<canvas>

## Tables

<table>  
<caption>  
<colgroup>  
<col>  
<thead>  
<tbody>  
<tfoot>  
<tr>  
<th>  
<td>

## Forms

<form>  
<label>  
<input>  
<button>  
<textarea>  
<select>  
<option>  
<optgroup>  
<datalist>  
<fieldset>  
<legend>  
<output>  
<progress>  
<meter>

## Interactive

<details>  
<summary>  
<dialog>  
<button>  
<a>

Form controls such as <input>, <select>, and <textarea> are also interactive.

## Scripting / Web Components

<script>  
<noscript>  
<template>  
<slot>

---

## 2. Parent / Container elements

A parent is an element that contains another element.

Common examples:

```
<html>
├─ <body>
│   └─ <div>
│       ├── <h1>
│       └─ <p>
```

Common container/parent-capable elements:

```
<html>
<head>
<body>
  <div>
    <section>
    <article>
    <header>
    <footer>
    <nav>
    <main>
    <aside>
    <form>
    <ul>
    <ol>
    <li>
    <table>
    <thead>
    <tbody>
```

```
<tfoot>
<tr>
<select>
<fieldset>
<figure>
<details>
```

---

### 3. Child elements

There is **no universal list of "child tags"** because a child depends on its parent.

For example:

`<ul> → <li>`

```
<ul>
  <li>HTML</li>
  <li>CSS</li>
</ul>
```

`<table> → <tr> → <td>`

```
<table>
  <tr>
    <td>Name</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

`<select> → <option>`

```
<select>
  <option>India</option>
  <option>USA</option>
</select>
```

<figure> → <img> + <figcaption>

```
<figure>
  
  <figcaption>My Photo</figcaption>
</figure>
```

---

## 4. Block-level elements

In traditional HTML/CSS terminology, common block-level elements include:

```
<address>
<article>
<aside>
<blockquote>
<div>
<dl>
<fieldset>
<figcaption>
<figure>
<footer>
<form>
<h1>–<h6>
<header>
<hr>
<main>
<nav>
<ol>
<p>
<pre>
<section>
```



<table>

<ul>

**Important:** Modern HTML itself doesn't classify elements simply as "block" or "inline" in the way older tutorials often do. CSS display controls the actual layout.

---

## 5. Inline / phrasing elements

Common inline/phrasing elements:

<a>

<abbr>

<b>

<bdi>

<bdo>

<br>

<button>

<cite>

<code>

<data>

<del>

<dfn>

<em>

<i>

<img>

<input>

<ins>

<kbd>

<label>

<mark>

<q>

<ruby>  
<s>  
<samp>  
<small>  
<span>  
<strong>  
<sub>  
<sup>  
<textarea>  
<time>  
<u>  
<var>  
<wbr>

Again, CSS can change their displayed layout.

---

## 6. Semantic elements

Semantic means the element communicates the **meaning/purpose** of its content.

### Page structure

<header>  
<nav>  
<main>  
<section>  
<article>  
<aside>  
<footer>  
<address>

## Content semantics

<h1>–<h6>

<p>

<figure>

<figcaption>

<time>

<mark>

<strong>

<em>

<blockquote>

<cite>

<abbr>

<code>

<data>

<del>

<ins>

---

## 7. Non-semantic elements

The two most important ones are:

<div>

Generic **block/container**.

<div>

Content

</div>

<span>

Generic **inline container**.

<span>Hello</span>

Easy rule

### **Semantic:**

"This tells me what the content is."

### **Non-semantic:**

"This is just a container."

---

## 8. Formatting / text elements

Common ones

| Tag      | Meaning                     |
|----------|-----------------------------|
| <b>      | Draw attention              |
| <strong> | Strong importance           |
| <i>      | Alternate voice/term        |
| <em>     | Emphasis                    |
| <u>      | Non-textual annotation      |
| <mark>   | Highlight                   |
| <small>  | Small print                 |
| <s>      | No longer accurate/relevant |
| <del>    | Deleted content             |

| Tag    | Meaning           |
|--------|-------------------|
| <ins>  | Inserted content  |
| <sub>  | Subscript         |
| <sup>  | Superscript       |
| <code> | Code              |
| <pre>  | Preformatted text |
| <kbd>  | Keyboard input    |
| <samp> | Program output    |
| <var>  | Variable          |

Example:

<strong>Important</strong>

<em>Emphasized</em>

<mark>Highlighted</mark>

H<sub>2</sub>O

X<sup>2</sup>

---

## 9. Interactive elements

<button>

<button>Submit</button>

<a>

<a href="https://example.com">Visit</a>

<details>

<details>

    <summary>More information</summary>

    <p>Additional content.</p>

</details>

<dialog>

Used for dialogs/modals.

<dialog>

    Hello!

</dialog>

Form controls

<input>

<select>

<option>

<textarea>

<button>

<datalist>

---

## 10. ⚠️ Obsolete/deprecated HTML tags

You may still see these in old tutorials, but **don't use them in new projects**:

<acronym>

<big>

<center>  
<content>  
<dir>  
<font>  
<frame>  
<frameset>  
<image>  
<marquee>  
<menuitem>  
<nobr>  
<param>  
<plaintext>  
<shadow>  
<strike>  
<tt>  
<xmp>

Some old elements have modern replacements.

For example:

<center>Hello</center>

✗ Old approach.

Use CSS instead:

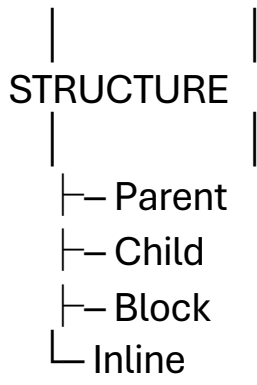
text-align: center;

---

🗺 Your HTML classification map

HTML ELEMENTS





- └ Semantic
- └ Non-semantic
- └ Formatting
  - └ Scripting

- └─ Interactive
  - └─ Form
- └─ Media

★ Most important tags for a beginner

If you're starting Full Stack, **don't try to memorize all tags at once.**  
Master these first:

<html>

## <head>

&lt;title&gt;

<body>

## <header>

<nav>

```
<main>
```

<section>

<article>

<aside>

<footer>

# <h1> - <h6>

<p>

<div>

<span>

<a>

<img>



<ul>

<ol>

<li>

<table>

<tr>

<th>

<td>

<form>

<label>

<input>

<textarea>

<select>

<option>

<button>

<strong>

<em>

<br>

<hr>